

Magic Rings Priority Matrix — Impact vs Complexity Analysis

Source: D&D 3.5e Dungeon Master’s Guide (pp. 229–233), Core Rules Only
Project: /home/ubuntu/dnd35prototype
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Scoring Methodology

Impact Score (1-5)

How much value the ring adds to gameplay and player experience:

Score	Label	Criteria
5	Critical	Core combat/survival mechanic, used constantly, iconic D&D item
4	High	Frequently useful, significant tactical value, broad applicability
3	Moderate	Situationally valuable, enhances specific builds or encounters
2	Low	Niche use cases, rarely changes outcomes
1	Minimal	Flavor/RP item, almost never mechanically relevant

Complexity Score (1-5)

Implementation difficulty considering existing systems:

Score	Label	Criteria
1	Trivial	Single stat modifier, existing system handles it
2	Simple	Few stat mods or one conditional trigger
3	Moderate	New UI/activation needed, multiple interacting effects
4	Hard	New subsystem required, complex state management
5	Very Hard	Multiple new systems, heavy AI/spell integration

Priority Score Formula

Priority Score = Impact × (6 - Complexity)

- Maximum possible: $5 \times 5 = 25$ (high impact, trivial complexity)
- Minimum possible: $1 \times 1 = 1$ (minimal impact, very hard complexity)

Higher score = implement sooner.

Complete Priority Matrix

Sorted by Priority Score (Descending)

Rank	Ring	Impact	Complexity	Priority Score	Tier	New Systems Needed
1	Protection +1 to +5	5	1	25	T1	None — Deflection-Bonus exists
2	Resistance, Minor/Major/Greater	5	1	25	T1	None — save bonus fields exist
3	Freedom of Movement	5	2	20	T1	None — spell already exists
4	Evasion	4	1	20	T1	None — HasEvasion exists
5	Force Shield	4	1	20	T1	None — ShieldBonus exists
6	Counter-spells	4	2	16	T2	Counter-spell trigger system
7	Invisibility	4	2	16	T2	Command activation UI
8	Spell Storing, Minor	4	3	12	T3	Spell storage system
9	Sustenance	3	1	15	T1	None (if hunger not tracked)
10	Climbing	3	1	15	T1	None — competence bo-

Rank	Ring	Impact	Complexity	Priority Score	Tier	New Systems Needed
						nus to Climb
11	Jumping	3	1	15	T1	None — competence bonus to Jump
12	Swimming	3	1	15	T1	None — competence bonus to Swim
13	Feather Falling	3	2	12	T1	Auto-trigger on fall detection
14	Mind Shielding	3	1	15	T1	None — immunity flags
15	Water Walking	2	2	8	T1	Movement system hook
16	Animal Friendship	3	2	12	T2	Charm animal mechanics
17	Chameleon Power	3	2	12	T2	Stealth bonus + activation
18	Energy Resistance, Minor/Major/Greater	4	2	16	T1	None — DamageResistances exists
19	Blinking	4	2	16	T2	Command activation UI

Rank	Ring	Impact	Complexity	Priority Score	Tier	New Systems Needed
20	Spell Turning	4	4	8	T3	SR-like reflection system
21	Ram	3	3	9	T2	Charge-based ranged force attack
22	Wizardry (I-IV)	4	2	16	T1	Bonus spell slot system
23	Regeneration	4	3	12	T3	Fast healing + regrowth system
24	Telekinesis	3	3	9	T2	Command activation + spell link
25	X-Ray Vision	2	4	4	T3	Vision/wall-piercing rendering
26	Friend Shield (pair)	2	3	6	T3	Paired item + damage sharing
27	Shooting Stars	3	4	6	T3	Multiple activated abilities, area effects
28	Spell Storing, Major	4	4	8	T3	Extended spell storage system
29	Three Wishes	3	4	6	T4	WishExecutor exists, needs

Rank	Ring	Impact	Complexity	Priority Score	Tier	New Systems Needed
						charge depletion
30	Djinni Calling	2	5	2	T4	Planar ally summoning AI
31	Elemental Command	3	5	3	T4	Multi-mode activated abilities, summon system
32	Air/Earth/Fire/Water	3	5	3	T4	(Variants of Elemental Command)
33	Spell Storing (standard)	4	3	12	T3	Spell storage system

Priority Quadrant Analysis

Quadrant 1: HIGH IMPACT / LOW COMPLEXITY — Implement First

Priority Score ≥ 15

Ring	I	C	PS	Notes
Protection +1-+5	5	1	25	Single field: De-flectionBonus
Resistance (all)	5	1	25	Single field per save type
Freedom of Movement	5	2	20	Existing spell, continuous
Evasion	4	1	20	Existing HasEva-sion flag
Force Shield	4	1	20	Existing Shield-Bonus field
Energy Resist-ance (all)	4	2	16	Existing Dam-ageResistances dict
Wizardry I-IV	4	2	16	Bonus spell slots per level
Counterspells	4	2	16	Reactive trigger
Invisibility	4	2	16	Existing spell + command UI
Blinking	4	2	16	Existing spell + command UI
Sustenance	3	1	15	Immunity flag
Climbing	3	1	15	+10 competence to Climb
Jumping	3	1	15	+10 competence to Jump
Swimming	3	1	15	+10 competence to Swim
Mind Shielding	3	1	15	Immunity flags

Total: 15 rings | Est. effort: 1-2 weeks

Quadrant 2: HIGH IMPACT / HIGH COMPLEXITY — Plan Carefully

Impact $\geq$ 4, Complexity $\geq$ 3

Ring	I	C	PS	Notes
Spell Storing (Minor)	4	3	12	Needs spell storage subsystem
Spell Storing (Standard)	4	3	12	Same system, higher level cap
Spell Storing (Major)	4	4	8	Same system, highest level cap
Regeneration	4	3	12	Fast healing + limb regrowth
Spell Turning	4	4	8	SR + reflection tracking

Total: 5 rings | Est. effort: 2-3 weeks

Quadrant 3: LOW IMPACT / LOW COMPLEXITY — Fill In Gaps

Impact ≤ 3 , Complexity ≤ 2

Ring	I	C	PS	Notes
Feather Falling	3	2	12	Auto-trigger, simple
Animal Friendship	3	2	12	Charm animal 1/day
Chameleon Power	3	2	12	Stealth bonus + disguise
Water Walking	2	2	8	Movement flag

Total: 4 rings | Est. effort: 3-5 days

Quadrant 4: LOW IMPACT / HIGH COMPLEXITY — Defer or Simplify

Impact ≤ 3 , Complexity ≥ 3

Ring	I	C	PS	Notes
Ram	3	3	9	Charge-based ranged attack
Telekinesis	3	3	9	Spell link + activation
Friend Shield	2	3	6	Paired item system
Shooting Stars	3	4	6	Multiple complex abilities
X-Ray Vision	2	4	4	Rendering system needed
Three Wishes	3	4	6	WishExecutor helps, but charges
Elemental Command (×4)	3	5	3	Most complex rings in game
Djinni Calling	2	5	2	Full summoning AI needed

Total: 9 rings | Est. effort: 3-4 weeks

Recommended Implementation Order

Sprint 1: Foundation + Quick Wins (Week 1-2)

Goal: Ring infrastructure + all Quadrant 1 rings

Order	Ring	PS	Why First
1	Protection +1-+5	25	Highest PS, tests slot system
2	Resistance (Minor/Major/Greater)	25	Same pattern, save bonuses
3	Evasion	20	Single flag flip
4	Force Shield	20	Single stat mod
5	Freedom of Movement	20	Tests continuous spell effect
6	Energy Resistance (all)	16	Existing damage resistance system
7	Wizardry I-IV	16	Important for casters
8	Invisibility	16	First command-word ring
9	Blinking	16	Second command-word ring
10	Counterspells	16	Reactive trigger pattern
11-15	Sustenance, Climbing, Jumping, Swimming, Mind Shielding	15	Simple stat/flag rings

Deliverables:

- RingFactory / RingDatabase — ring registration pipeline
- RecalculateStats() updated to process ring slots
- Command-word activation UI (reusable for all future rings)
- 15+ rings fully functional

Sprint 2: Moderate Systems (Week 3-4)

Goal: Quadrant 2 + Quadrant 3 rings

Order	Ring	PS	Why Now
16	Spell Storing (Minor)	12	Builds spell storage system
17	Spell Storing (Standard)	12	Extends same system
18	Regeneration	12	Fast healing ticker
19	Feather Falling	12	Auto-trigger pattern
20	Animal Friendship	12	Charm effect 1/day
21	Chameleon Power	12	Stealth + disguise
22	Ram	9	Charge-based force attack
23	Telekinesis	9	Links to existing spell

Deliverables:

- Spell storage subsystem (reusable for other items)
- Charge depletion system
- Auto-trigger framework
- 8 more rings functional (23 total)

Sprint 3: Complex Rings (Week 5-7)

Goal: Quadrant 2 remainder + select Quadrant 4

Order	Ring	PS	Why Now
24	Spell Storing (Major)	8	Extends existing storage system
25	Spell Turning	8	SR + reflection
26	Water Walking	8	Movement hook
27	Three Wishes	6	WishExecutor exists
28	Shooting Stars	6	Multi-ability ring
29	Friend Shield	6	Paired item prototype

Deliverables:

- Spell reflection system
- Wish charge depletion
- Multi-ability ring framework
- 6 more rings (29 total)

Sprint 4: Legendary Rings (Week 8-10)

Goal: Remaining Quadrant 4 — defer if needed

Order	Ring	PS	Notes
30	X-Ray Vision	4	May simplify to skill bonus
31	Elemental Command (Air)	3	Template for all variants
32	Elemental Command (Earth/Fire/Water)	3	Clone + customize
33	Djinni Calling	2	Requires summoning AI

Deliverables:

- Elemental command multi-mode framework
 - Summoning/calling subsystem
 - All 33 ring types complete
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Summary Statistics

Metric	Value
Total Rings	33 types (47 variants)
Average Priority Score	12.1
Median Priority Score	12
Highest Priority	Protection, Resistance (25)
Lowest Priority	Djinni Calling (2)
Quadrant 1 (do first)	15 rings (45%)
Quadrant 2 (plan carefully)	5 rings (15%)
Quadrant 3 (fill gaps)	4 rings (12%)
Quadrant 4 (defer)	9 rings (27%)
Rings using only existing systems	15 (45%)
Rings needing command activation UI	8 (24%)
Rings needing new subsystems	10 (30%)
Estimated total effort	8-10 weeks

Risk Assessment

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
<code>RecalculateStats()</code> ring integration breaks existing gear	Medium	High	Unit test all existing equipment before/after
Command activation UI delays	Medium	Medium	Stub with auto-activate; add UI later
Spell storage system scope creep	High	Medium	Implement Minor first, gate Major behind it
Elemental Command scope explosion	High	High	Implement as simplified stat rings first; add modes incrementally
Ring of Three Wishes balance issues	Low	High	Gate behind DM confirmation dialog

This matrix should be reviewed after Sprint 1 completion. Actual complexity may shift once the ring infrastructure is built and shared systems are available for reuse.